

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

THURSDAY, JULY 10, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 8

WSJ.com

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Nvidia became the first** company to reach a market value of \$4 trillion, beating Apple and Microsoft to the milestone in trading on the Nasdaq exchange. **A1**
- ◆ **The tech-heavy index** itself reached a record, advancing 0.9%, while the S&P 500 and Dow rose 0.6% and 0.5%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **A brewing debate** inside the Fed about how to address risks posed by Trump's tariffs has the potential to put officials at odds over whether new cost increases justify keeping interest rates high. **A2**
- ◆ **Linda Yaccarino said** she is stepping down as chief executive of X, capping a tumultuous run atop Elon Musk's social-media company. **A1**
- ◆ **Merck struck** a roughly \$10 billion deal to buy Verona Pharma, bolstering its lineup with the chronic obstructive pulmonary disease treatment Ohtuvayre as it braces for the 2028 loss of patent exclusivity for the cancer drug Keytruda. **B1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** is investigating UnitedHealth's Medicare billing practices, including how the company deployed doctors and nurses to gather diagnoses that bolstered its payments. **B1**
- ◆ **The chief executive** of stadium developer Oak View Group was charged with conspiring with a rival to rig the process for constructing a new arena in Texas, authorities said. **B1**
- ◆ **WPP's U.S.-listed shares** plunged 18% after the advertising agency cut its guidance and said that it expects uncertainty to weigh on client spending and new business. **B4**

World-Wide

- ◆ **As Trump met with** the leaders of five West African countries, his administration was pushing them to agree to accept migrants deported by the U.S. whose home countries refuse or are slow to take them back. **A5**
- ◆ **France and the U.K. said** they would coordinate the use of their nuclear weapons and respond to any major threat to Europe together. **A16**
- ◆ **Torrential floods hit** southern New Mexico and killed at least three people, days after historic floods devastated Central Texas. **A6**
- ◆ **A local agency** that helps manage the Guadalupe River was in the process of setting up a software program to help Kerr County officials better assess flood threats three months before the deadly Texas floods. **A6**
- ◆ **The U.S. will charge** a 50% tariff on Brazilian goods starting Aug. 1, Trump said, citing legal action against Brazil's former President Jair Bolsonaro and U.S. tech firms. **A2**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** attacked Harvard's accreditation, saying the university has violated federal discrimination law and may no longer meet accreditation standards. **A3**
- ◆ **Weeks after Elon Musk** left his role at the Department of Government Efficiency, a small band of loyalists is fighting to preserve the legacy and power of the office. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump named** Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy to serve as interim administrator of NASA, after pushing out his original nominee to run the space agency. **A4**

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Nvidia Is First to \$4 Trillion

Chip maker is at heart of AI boom in gaming, data centers and crypto

Nvidia became the first company in history to reach a market value of \$4 trillion, beating rivals Apple and Microsoft to

By Robbie Whelan, Asa Fitch and Muhammad Shumail

the milestone in Wednesday morning trading on the tech-heavy Nasdaq exchange. The AI chip giant has seen

its fortunes surge over the last three years because of the rise of generative artificial intelligence, an emerging technology that promises to revolutionize business and remake how humans interact with technology across the globe.

Nvidia, based in Santa Clara, Calif., designs the chips, known as graphics processing units, or GPUs, that power the AI industry. The rally in Nvidia's shares caps a remarkable run and comes barely two years after the company notched a \$1 trillion closing valuation for the first time. The AI chip maker, which closed at \$162.88 a

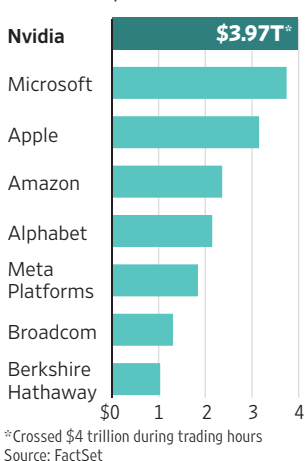
share and just shy of the \$4 trillion mark, is now worth as much as the 214 smallest companies in the S&P 500 combined, according to Dow Jones Market Data.

Apple and Microsoft have come close to the \$4 trillion mark. Apple closed with a market cap of \$3.915 trillion in late 2024, and Microsoft had a valuation of \$3.708 trillion last week.

Founded by Taiwanese-American engineer Jensen Huang in 1993, Nvidia initially

◆ **Nvidia fuels gains in U.S. indexes..... B11**

Companies with a market value over \$1 trillion



A view of a cell corridor in the Saydnaya prison, near Damascus, Syria, where executions took place on a mass scale.

A Syrian Death Factory Gives Up Its Secrets; 'Symbol of Shame'

Under deposed dictator Assad, Saydnaya prison became a mass-killing machine

By JARED MALSIN AND HAMZA BONDUK

SAYDNAYA, Syria—Inside Bashar al-Assad's most-notorious death factory, the hangings had become routine.

Once a month, around midnight, the guards at Saydnaya prison would call the names of the condemned, usually dozens at a time. They wrapped nooses around their necks, then dragged tables from beneath their feet with a scraping that echoed through the

building. Those in nearby cells heard a gagging sound as the men choked to death.

Then, in mid-March of 2023, the pace picked up dramatically, according to six witnesses.

"They gathered 600 people and killed them in three days, about 200 each night," said Abdel Moneim Al-Qaid, a 37-year-old former rebel soldier who was arrested after handing himself in for what he thought was an am-

nesty deal with the government.

The 2023 mass killing, previously unreported, came just as the Syrian president was poised to break out of his international isolation. After more than a decade of using bombing, torture and chemical attacks to crush an internal insurrection, Assad was deep in talks with regional players to rejoin the Arab League. Some Arab states and Western officials viewed the rebellion

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Two Kevins Are Vying To Head The Fed

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ AND NICK TIMIRAO

WASHINGTON—Two Republicans named Kevin are vying to be the next chairman of the Federal Reserve. One is rising to the top of the list of potential candidates, while the other is facing skepticism from President Trump's allies.

Kevin Hassett, one of Trump's closest economic advisers, is emerging as a serious contender to be the next Fed chair, according to people familiar with the matter. Hassett's rise threatens the other Kevin—former Fed governor Kevin Warsh—an early favorite for the job who has angled for the position ever since Trump passed him over for it eight years ago. Some people close to the president worry that Warsh, who isn't in Trump's inner circle, won't be a champion of lower rates.

What is unfolding is quintessential Trump: two ambitious men competing for his

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◆ **Split Fed clouds future rate cuts..... A2**

INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
Measles cases in U.S. surge to highest level in 33 years as vaccination rates fall. **A3**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Italian candy maker Ferrero nears \$3 billion deal to acquire Kellogg. **B1**

Matcha Lovers Turn Against Each Other Over Global Shortage

Dedicated tea drinkers are rationing, squabbling—and hating on hoarders

By KRISTAL HUR

MatchaTok is green with envy these days.

The online community for matcha lovers, which helped propel the bright green powdered tea's worldwide popularity, is usually a place where enthusiasts share their golden

matcha-to-milk ratio for concocting lattes at home, review different brands and detail their drink-making process.

But what's brewing on MatchaTok lately is trouble.

"It's kind of gotten bad in places," said Kimi Jeyasiri, a 27-year-old content creator.

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Israel's Agonizing Choice Over Hostages: 'It's Schindler's List'

By ANAT PELED

TEL AVIV—Only 20 of the hostages Hamas is holding in Gaza are believed to be alive. A cease-fire deal being negotiated is expected to bring an agonizing choice over who to free. Israel can only pick 10.

"It's Schindler's list," said Anat Angrest, mother of captive soldier Matan Angrest, 22 years old, who said her son was injured. "I don't understand how the state can choose who should stay in hell."

Israel and Hamas are now hammering out a deal that would see the release of 10 living hostages and the bodies of 18 others in exchange for a 60-day cease-fire and the release of Palestinian prisoners held in Israel. A deal appears to be closer than at any point in recent months.

In two previous cease-fires, the decisions, while painful, were easier to rationalize. Priority was given to civilian women, children and the elderly. Next in line were female soldiers or injured men.

Now, all of the living hostages are men, and they are all likely to be deteriorating mentally and physically. For the

Yaccarino Steps Down As CEO of Musk's X

Her departure from the social-media platform follows the merger of xAI and X

Linda Yaccarino said she is stepping down as chief executive of X, capping a tumultuous run atop Elon Musk's social-media company.

By Suzanne Vranica, Alexander Saeedy and Jessica Toonkel

Yaccarino's future at the company had been uncertain for months. Musk merged X with Grok chatbot maker xAI this spring, fusing two of his technology bets and making the social-media platform part of a broader AI-focused company.

The high-growth potential of artificial intelligence became more important to investors than the tighter-margin social-media business overseen by Yaccarino.

When X hired the former finance chief of Tubi, Reza Banki, as the social-media company's chief financial officer late last year, he and Yaccarino often butted heads, people familiar with their relationship said.

Banki was a hire supported by Musk and effectively replaced Yaccarino's previously appointed head of finance for the company. He pressured Yaccarino over costs, specifically over the money she was spending on content deals with celebrities for shows that appear on X, one of the people said.

Yaccarino told people close to her that the recent return of some advertisers and the merger, which made X a smaller revenue contributor, made it a good time to depart.

X is expected to see ad-revenue growth for the first time since the takeover this year, according to research firm eMarketer.

"When @elonmusk and I first spoke of his vision for X, I knew it would be the opportunity of a lifetime to carry out the extraordinary mission of this company. I'm im-

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◆ **Musk's allies at DOGE fight on..... A4**

families still waiting, the decision is creating deep despair.

The Israeli prime minister's office didn't respond to a request for comment about how it chooses which hostages should be released.

Ilay David knows that his brother, Evyatar David, 24, who was kidnapped from the Nova music festival, is likely not a top priority for release as he is young and uninjured, even if he faces harsh conditions in captivity.

"We understood early on that Evyatar...was never going to be among the first," David said. But for Evyatar to be left behind again would shatter him: "This knowledge that your brother is still there, still suffering, is really unbearable. I pray that we won't reach a situation where he is left there."

Hostage families have insisted that any deal should include the release of all hostages at once rather than in phases. Many families are angry at the Israeli government over the partial deals it has negotiated. Hamas has said it would release all the hostages in exchange for an end to the war, something Israel refuses to do

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